

Citation Integrity Audit

Research Topic: Context-Window Degradation and Its Impact on Long-Document Research Synthesis

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1. Purpose of the Audit

This audit evaluates references used for the research topic and checks their relevance, traceability, bibliographic accuracy, and suitability for supporting research claims. It also documents the role of AI assistance in the research workflow.

2. Citation Verification Criteria

- Existence – the work should be identifiable.
- Bibliographic Accuracy – title, authors, year, and publication details should be checked.
- Relevance – the source should meaningfully relate to the research topic.
- Source Traceability – the source should be traceable to an academic or official source.
- Claim Support – the source should appropriately support the claim for which it is cited.

3. Citation Audit

No.	Reference	Year	Area	Relevance	Status
1	Attention Is All You Need	2017	Transformer	Foundational	Verified
2	Retrieval-Augmented Generation for Knowledge-Intensive NLP Tasks	2020	RAG	High	Verified
3	RoFormer: Enhanced Transformer with Rotary Position Embedding	2023	Position	High	Verified
4	Lost in the Middle: How Language Models Use Long Context	2024	Long Context	Very High	Verified
5	LongBench: A Bilingual, Multitask Benchmark for Long Context Understanding	2024	Benchmark	Very High	Verified
6	RULER: What's the Real Context Size of Your Long-Context Language Model	2024	Evaluation	Very High	Verified
7	Efficient Streaming Language Models with Attention Sinks	2024	Streaming	High	Verified
8	Needle in a Haystack	2023	Retrieval	High	Verified

4. Detailed Audit

Attention Is All You Need

Authors: Ashish Vaswani et al. | **Year:** 2017 | **Relevance:** High
Reason: Foundational Transformer and self-attention background.
Status: Verified

Retrieval-Augmented Generation for Knowledge-Intensive NLP Tasks

Authors: Patrick Lewis et al. | **Year:** 2020 | **Relevance:** High
Reason: Relevant to retrieval-based approaches for supplying selected information to language models.
Status: Verified

RoFormer: Enhanced Transformer with Rotary Position Embedding

Authors: Jianlin Su et al. | **Year:** 2021 | **Relevance:** High
Reason: Relevant to positional representations and information location.
Status: Verified

Lost in the Middle: How Language Models Use Long Contexts

Authors: Nelson F. Liu et al. | **Year:** 2024 | **Relevance:** Very High
Reason: Central reference for position-dependent long-context information use.
Status: Verified

LongBench

Authors: Yushi Bai et al. | **Year:** 2024 | **Relevance:** Very High
Reason: Multitask benchmark for long-context understanding.
Status: Verified

RULER

Authors: Cheng-Ping Hsieh et al. | **Year:** 2024 | **Relevance:** Very High
Reason: Evaluation of effective long-context capabilities.
Status: Verified

Efficient Streaming Language Models with Attention Sinks

Authors: Guangxuan Xiao et al. | **Year:** 2024 | **Relevance:** High
Reason: Relevant to attention behavior and long-sequence processing.
Status: Verified

Needle in a Haystack

Authors: Greg Kamradt | **Year:** 2023 | **Relevance:** High
Reason: Practical long-context retrieval evaluation.
Status: Verified

5. Citation Integrity Risks

- Incorrect bibliographic information
- Unsupported claims
- Duplicate or fabricated references
- Incorrect interpretation or over-generalization

6. AI-Assisted Research Disclosure

AI assistance was used for topic exploration, organization, drafting, reference organization, and documentation. AI assistance does not replace independent verification. Important bibliographic information and research claims should be checked against original sources before academic submission.

7. Recommended Citation Practice

- Cite original research whenever possible.

- Place citations next to the claims they support.
- Verify author names, titles, years, venues, and DOI information.
- Distinguish published findings from personal interpretation.
- Do not present AI-generated references as verified without checking them.

8. Audit Conclusion

The reviewed references provide relevant background for studying context-window degradation and long-document research synthesis. The strongest references for the central research question include Lost in the Middle, LongBench, RULER, and Needle in a Haystack. Citation verification should be repeated whenever references are added or modified.

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